four main questions that quickly turn into full-blown problems:

1. What data do we have available?
2. Where is this data?
3. How can I access this data?
4. What is the quality of this data?

Data governance helps answer these questions by assigning responsibilities and metrics related to data findability, availability, and usability. Well-designed data governance will ensure that a known and accountable entity, responsible for the development and maintenance of a continuously updated data catalog, offers insight into what data is available and its access requirements. That data catalog provides a straight answer to the first two previously listed questions.

Data governance also covers concerns related to data security and safety, including access rights and permissions. Again, data governance clearly indicates who is responsible for each bit of data, who can by default use it, and the allowed access protocols. With such a structure in place, the answer to question 3 is easy for data consumers to find.

Similarly, data governance means assigning responsibility for metadata management. It means there should be a clear definition of data quality metrics, and a clear indication of parties and tools ensuring availability of accurate metadata for each data asset.

The conclusion is obvious: data governance done right offers all means for data to become FAIR, a cornerstone of wide usability.

6.2.3 Data control perspective

We operate in an era of a constant struggle, as companies and parties are willing to go to great lengths to profit from illegal acquisition of company data or to prove in court that data was mishandled or misused by the company. As a result, the data environment’s security, safety, and legal compliance is not a mere luxury, but a necessity. One of the outcomes of data governance is clear ownership of data at each stage of its life cycle.